

Mortar and pestle

Lead

Tin

Talc

Green fig

PASTY PASTES

There were various recipes for white face makeup, or ceruse. One was a mixture of talc and tin, which was burned in a furnace for three days. The ash was then ground up with green figs and vinegar using a mortar and pestle. Another recipe used poisonous lead as an ingredient.

English roses

Pale skin was seen as a sign of nobility, because people with tanned skin were likely to be manual workers who spent most of their time in the sun. Another sign of beauty was a pair of blushing, rosy cheeks. Boy players used the same kind of makeup as noblewomen when they were acting the parts of court ladies.

A SPLASH OF COLOR
Red blusher was made by grinding a mineral called cinnabar or by crushing the roots of the madder plant. The red pigment, known as vermilion or fucus, was used to add color to the cheeks and the lips.

Cinnabar

Rosalind's dress is one of the most expensive costumes in the tiring house

Padded sleeves

Flat, stiff front called a stomacher

Luxurious beaded satin fabric

A fluttering fan made a good prop for a boy playing a woman

5 WALK LIKE A WOMAN

The dress is fitted over everything to complete the outfit, and the boy steps into a pair of high-heeled shoes. These will be hidden by the long dress, but wearing them will help him to walk on the stage in a stately and ladylike manner.

6 MISTRESS OF MIRTH

After putting on makeup, a small ruff, and a wig, the boy player's transformation into a woman is complete. He is ready to step out on to the playhouse stage as Rosalind. He repeats his first line to himself: "Dear Celia, I show more mirth than I am mistress of," and nervously flicks his fan.